manner. Some Afghans of rank, entered his house upon pretence of paying him a friendly visit and when in, killed him, whilst others went to visit and killed in the same way, the officers who were attached to him, and who were living in the town. The rebels then seized some stores and two cannon which were in the town and attacked the palace where the King Shiyah ul Mulh was living but were repulsed. There were some British troops in cantonments outside the town and these on the one side and the king from his fortress the "Balla Hissar" on the other bombarded the town and reduced it to ashes. The 4,000 British troops have since had two actions with the insurgents and have retaken the two guns and a part of the military stores. And they (the British) believe that they have killed about 35,000 of the Afghans but the latter are still reinforced from the mountains where the people are all up in arms. Shiyah ul Mulh has about 1,200 men with him in his palace and some cannon therefore the insurgents are placed between two fires. At Candahar we have an army of 12,000 men but they can not stir to the assistance of the unfortunate 4,000 who are at Canbul until the spring because the mountain passes between Candahar and Canbul are so blocked up with snow that an army can not pass for I should think at least four months,[59] therefore these unfortunate 4,000 men will have to fight against perhaps 100,000 men for at least four months for this affair happened in the month of Novr last. It is said that they are about to augment the army of Afghanistan to 50,000. I am not sorry for this because the expenses will fall upon the company and not upon the British Government, and it will only run the Company a little into debt which all who have money to invest in India are glad of for they get 6–8 and sometimes 10% for their money. An officer of the mission at Tehran has been sent to Khiva[60] to endeavour to put an end to the infamous Traffic in slaves which has been carried on by the turcomans and tartar tribes on the eastern frontiers of Persia for now nearly a century. These tribes being Soonee and the Persians Sheeah (two enimical sects of Mahommedans) the former consider that is perfectly lawful according to their religion to carry off and sell into slavery the latter, the Sheeahs: and the slavery is the worst that exists in the world, they are employed as agricultural laborers ill fed and well beaten. Very unlike the slaves in Persia who are employed as house servants and if they behave well are treated as one of the sons of their master and frequently marry one of his daughters. Persia is much in the same state as it has been for years back, that is as bad as possible. The army and govt servts unpaid, some provinces in open

[59] This proved to be the case; General Pollock was unable to march to the relief of the Canbul garrison until the following spring, by which time the 4,000 men had been massacred.

[60] The officer was Capt. Stoddard, attended by Lieut. Conolly. This begins the famous "Bokhara incident."

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